NATURA

CONDITION-AWARE GROWING

TWELVE-MONTH PLANTING CALENDAR

Mediterranean container planting calendar

A practical month-by-month rhythm for edible containers in a mild Mediterranean climate, with local weather checks built into every decision.

MEDITERRANEAN | NORTHERN HEMISPHERE | CONTAINER

HOW TO USE THIS CALENDAR

Designed for mild-winter Northern Hemisphere locations with hot, dry summers and container-based growing.

Check local forecasts and growing conditions before acting.

01

JANUARY

mediterranean climate | container | northern hemisphere

2 PRIORITY TASKS

PLAN

NORMAL

Review light and container drainage

Map winter sun, clean drainage holes, and replace only exhausted or compacted growing medium.

SOW INDOORS

LOW

Start slow warm-season crops indoors

Where reliable warmth and strong light are available, begin a small batch of peppers or aubergines.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

02

FEBRUARY

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2 PRIORITY TASKS

SOW INDOORS

NORMAL

Start tomatoes under protection

Sow a manageable number with warmth and strong light; delay if seedlings would become weak indoors.

CARE

NORMAL

Refresh perennial herbs

Trim damaged growth lightly and check rosemary, thyme, and oregano containers for drainage.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

03

MARCH

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2 PRIORITY TASKS

SOW OUTDOORS

NORMAL

Sow quick cool-season crops

Try radish, salad leaves, coriander, or chard where conditions are mild and moisture can be maintained.

PLANT

HIGH

Pot up strawberries and hardy herbs

Keep strawberry crowns level with the surface and allow space for airflow.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

04

APRIL

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2 PRIORITY TASKS

PLANT

HIGH

Move tender crops out gradually

Harden plants off and wait through any unusual cold or damaging wind before permanent placement.

SOW OUTDOORS

NORMAL

Sow basil when nights are warm

Basil needs reliably warm conditions; keep a protected backup if nights remain cool.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

05

MAY

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2 PRIORITY TASKS

CARE

NORMAL

Install support before plants are heavy

Stake tomatoes early and confirm containers remain stable in wind.

PLANT

HIGH

Complete warm-season planting

Plant tomatoes, basil, and other warm crops once nights and forecasts are suitable.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

06

JUNE

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2 PRIORITY TASKS

CARE — HIGH

Shift to heat-aware watering

Check moisture early, water deeply when needed, and use mulch without blocking stems.

HARVEST — NORMAL

Harvest herbs little and often

Take small regular cuts to encourage branching and remove flowering stems where leaf production is the goal.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

07

JULY

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2 PRIORITY TASKS

PROTECT

HIGH

Protect roots during extreme heat

Shade dark containers, move sensitive plants out of reflected afternoon heat, and check moisture more often.

HARVEST

NORMAL

Pick tomatoes as they ripen

Harvest regularly and inspect plants while picking for stress, pests, or split fruit.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

08

AUGUST

mediterranean climate | container | northern hemisphere

2 PRIORITY TASKS

SOW INDOORS

NORMAL

Prepare autumn salad seedlings

Start small batches in a cooler protected position rather than sowing into extreme heat.

CARE

NORMAL

Remove exhausted summer growth

Clear only finished or unhealthy material and keep productive plants supported and watered.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

09

SEPTEMBER

mediterranean climate | container | northern hemisphere

2 PRIORITY TASKS

SOW OUTDOORS — HIGH

Sow the main autumn salad succession

Use salad leaves, coriander, radish, and other suitable cool-season crops as heat eases.

PLANT — NORMAL

Replant containers for autumn

Refresh only the medium that needs replacing and choose crops for the available autumn light.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

10

OCTOBER

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2 PRIORITY TASKS

PLANT

NORMAL

Set out hardy leafy crops and herbs

Use sheltered positions and avoid crowding as light levels and drying slow down.

CARE

HIGH

Reduce watering frequency

Continue checking below the surface, but expect containers to dry more slowly.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

11

NOVEMBER

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2 PRIORITY TASKS

PROTECT

HIGH

Prepare for wind and cold rain

Secure containers, raise vulnerable pots for drainage, and move tender herbs to protection if necessary.

HARVEST

NORMAL

Use cool-season leaves regularly

Harvest outer leaves and keep the centre growing where the crop allows.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.

12

DECEMBER

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2 PRIORITY TASKS

PLAN

NORMAL

Record what worked this year

Note successful positions, container sizes, watering problems, and varieties before planning the next cycle.

PROTECT

HIGH

Keep roots out of standing water

Check saucers after rain and maintain airflow around overwintering plants.

BEFORE ACTING

Local frost, heatwaves, altitude, wind, and coastal exposure can shift tasks by several weeks.